

Shams-ud-din Iltutmish

- He was the real founder of the Delhi Sultanate. He made Delhi as the capital of the empire. He suppressed the revolts of ambitious nobles, fought with the sons of Aibak and sent expeditions against the Rajputs in Ranthambore, Jalor, Mewar.
- His governing class was entirely of foreign origin. It consisted of two groups, Turkish slave officers and Tazik. He introduced the silver coin (tanka) and the copper coin (jital). He organised the Iqta system and introduced reforms in civil administration and army, which was now paid and recruited.
- He set-up official nobility of slaves known as *Turkan-i-Chalgani* or *Chalisa* (a group of forty powerful Turkish nobles).
- On 18th February, 1229 the Khalifa sent emissaries from Baghdad with a decree registering the independent status of the Delhi Sultanate. Iltutmish was called the father of **Tomb building** (built Sultan Garhi). He completed Qutub Minar.
- He saved Delhi Sultanate from the wrath of Chengiz Khan, the Mongol leader, by refusing shelter to Khwarizm Shah, whom Chengiz Khan was chasing.

Razia Sultan

- She was the first and the last Muslim woman ruler of medieval India. The first rebellion against her was raised by Kabir Khan, the Governor of Lahore.
- **Altunia** the Governor of Bhatinda was also a revolutionary. So, she moved straight towards Bhatinda, but was defeated and taken as prisoner by Altunia, who married her.
- Razia with her husband was moving towards Delhi. She was defeated by Bahram Shah, a son of Iltutmish. Deserted by her soldiers, she was murdered by robbers.
- *Razia succession continued, in which three rulers ruled in continuity*
 - i. Bahram Shah (AD 1240-1242)
 - ii. Ala-ud-din Masud Shah (AD 1242-1246)
 - iii. Nasir-ud-din Mahmud (AD 1246-1266)
- Nasir-ud-din was the grandson of Iltutmish.

Balban

- Balban ascended the throne in 1266-67 with host of problems. The first and foremost among these was the future relationship of the nobility with the king.
- He ordered the separation of the military department from the Finance Department (*Diwan-i-Wizarat*) and the former was placed under a Minister for Military Affairs (*Diwan-i-Ariz*).

- He impressed upon the people that kingship was the vice regency of God on Earth (*Niyabat-i-Khudai*) and its dignity was next only to prophethood. The King was the shadow of God (*Zil-i-Ilahi*). Balban abandoned the chalisa.
- Balban introduced *Sijdah* or *Paibos* and started *Nauroz* festival. Balban took strong measures to safeguard the North-West frontier against the Mongol invasions.
- His son Mohammed's death was a mashing blow to Balban and the death-knell to his dynasty. He was deeply racist and excluded non-Turks from the administration. The last ruler of dynasty was Kaiqubad, he was killed by Jalal-ud-din Khilji, who established Khilji dynasty.

The Khiljis

- The coming of the Khiljis to power was more than a dynastic change. Their ascendancy is known as *Khilji Revolution*, because it marked the end of monopolisation of power by the Turkish nobility and racial dictatorship.
- The accession of Jalal-ud-din, Firoz Khilji marked the end of an epoch and signified a 'revolution' in the political and cultural history of medieval India.

Jalal-ud-din Firoz Khilji

- He was an old man of 70, when he came to the throne and was unable to deal firmly with the problem of those troubled times.
- In order to win goodwill of Mongols, the Sultan married one of his daughter to the Mongol leader Ulugh Khan, a descendant of Chengiz Khan.
- One of the most important events of Jalal-ud-din's reign was the invasion of Devagiri the capital of the Yadava kingdom in the Deccan by Ala-ud-din (his nephew) and son-in-law of the Sultan and Governor of Kara.

Ala-ud-din Khilji

- His first major conquest was the rich kingdom of Gujarat, which was then ruled by the Vaghela King Karna.
- In 1299, Ala-ud-din's army under the joint command of Ulugh Khan and Nusrat Khan invaded Anhilwad, the capital of Gujarat.
- During plunder of the rich port of Cambay, Ala-ud-din's Commander Nusrat Khan acquired a Hindu turned Muslim slave Kafur (also known as Hazar Dinari), who later on rose to become a great Military General and the Malik Naib of Ala-ud-din.
- After the conquest of Gujarat, Ala-ud-din moved to Rajputana, where he conquered Ranthambore in 1300-1301 from Hamir Deva a descendant of Prithviraj III. In 1303 AD, he attacked Chittor the capital of Mewar, which was being ruled by Gahlot King Ratan Singh, whose queen Padmini committed Jauhar when her husband was defeated.

- Ala-ud-din Khilji is known for his market reform policy. He established four separate market in Delhi. Market was put under control of officer called Shahna-i-Mandi. Price of commodities were fixed, merchants were registered with market. Separate department Diwani Riyasat was created and Naib-i-Riyasat was officer responsible for new department. Secret agent 'Munhiyas' were appointed to inform Sultan about condition of market.
- Ala-ud-din Khilji started measurement of land and land revenue were collected in cash also. He also introduced dagh system (branding of horse), huliya (list of soldier) and cash payment to soldier.
- Hauz Khas, Mahal Hazar Satoon and Jamait Khana Mosque were built by Ala-ud-din. He adopted the title *Sikandar-i-Sani*.
- Added the entrance door to Qutab Minar, built Alai Darwaza and built his capital at Siri fort. Last Ruler was Qutub-ud-din Mubarak Khilji.
- He patronised the famous Persian poet Amir Khusrau, who was known as Tuti-i-Hind (Parrot of India). Khusrau also invented sitar by modifying veena.

The Tughlaqs

The Tughlaqs were a Muslim family of Turkish origin. They provided three competent rulers- Ghiyas-ud-din, Mohammed-bin-Tughlaq and Firoz Shah Tughlaq.

Ghiyas-ud-din Tughlaq

- Ghiyas-ud-din Tughlaq (real name Ghazi Malik) founded the third dynasty of the Sultanate. He also discarded Ala-ud-din's system of measurement of land for the assessment of land revenue.
- He took keen interest in the construction of canals for irrigation and formulated a famine policy to provide relief to peasants in the time of drought.
- He built the fortified city of Tughlaqabad and gave a new touch to the architecture of the Sultanate period.
- He established his capital at Tughlaqabad. He came in conflict with Sufi Saint Nizam-ud-din Auliya.

Mohammed-bin-Tughlaq

- Mohammed-bin-Tughlaq (real name Jauna Khan) succeeded Ghiyas-ud-din Tughlaq under title Mohammed-bin-Tughlaq. He was the most remarkable personality among the Sultans of Delhi.

Few ambitious projects taken up by Mohammed during his period are as follow

- Shifting the capital from Delhi to Devagiri (Daulatabad) in 1327. He wanted to control South India better, from Daulatabad but Daulatabad was found to be unsuitable because it was not possible to control North India from there. So, he decided to re-transfer the capital to Delhi.
- Introduction of the token currency (1329-30). (introduction of bronze *tankas* in place of silver *tankas*).

The value of token coin was equal to a silver coin. But, this experiment failed on account of the circulation of counterfeit coins on a very large scale and rejected by foreign merchants. So, he withdrew the token currency. He offered to exchange all the token coins for silver coins.

- The Sultan planned an expedition for the conquest of Khurasan and Iraq, but the scheme was abandoned, when the Sultan learnt that conditions in Iraq had improved.
- The plan for the conquest of Quarachil (Kumaun Hills) met with a disastrous end. Quarachil has been identified with Rajput state in the Kumaun-Garhwal region.
- He increased the revenue and set-up new department for agriculture *Diwan-i-Amir Koh*. **Ibn Battuta** (the famous traveller) came to Delhi in 1334. He acted as Qazi of the capital for 8 years.
- Ibn Battuta has recorded the contemporary Indian scene in his *Safarnamah* called Rehla. Battuta was a moroccan explorer. His travel account tell us about his journey through the Delhi Sultanate period.
- During his period, Vijayanagara empire was established in AD 1336 by Harihara and Bukka, and Bahamani Kingdom AD 1346 by Hasan Gangu Behman Shah.

Firoz Shah Tughlaq

- Firoz Shah Tughlaq, who became Sultan in AD 1351 was a patron of arts and literature. He did not give any harsh punishment and banned the inhuman practices like cutting hands, nose etc.

He abolished as many as twenty-three taxes and substituted them with only the following four taxes

- Kharaj (a land tax equal to 1/10 of the produce of the land)
 - Jaziya (a tax paid by non-Muslims)
 - Zakat (tax on property (2.5%))
 - Khams (1/5th of booty captured in war)
- He also made the civil and military post hereditary. One remarkable feature of his reign was his interest in civil works. He founded a number of new cities and towns, three most famous being Hissar, Fatehabad, Jaunpur and Firozabad, Firoz Shah Kotla (in Delhi).
 - To beautify his new capital Firozabad in Delhi the Ashokan pillars were brought, one from Topara in Ambala and the other from Meerut.
 - He was very fond of collecting a large number of slaves (about 180000 slaves) and had a separate department for it known as *Diwan-i-Bandagan*.
 - He set-up a separate department, called the *Diwan-i-Khairat*, for the help of the poor and the needy. He built *Dar-ul-Shafa* or a charitable hospital.

- Ziauddin Barani (the historian) was in his court) wrote two well-known works of history the *Tarikh-i-Firozshahi* and the *Fatwa-i-Jahandari*.
- He introduced two new coins *Adha* (50% jital) and *Bikh* (25% jital). He wrote his autobiography *The Fatuh-i-Firozshahi*. Timur invaded India during his reign.

TIMUR INVASION

During Nasir-ud-din Mahmud's (last ruler) reign, Timur the Mongol leader of Central Asia invaded India. Timur reached Delhi in December 1398 and ordered general massacre.

The Sayyids

- **Khizr Khan**, the founder of the Sayyid dynasty, had collaborated with Timur and as a reward for services to the invader and was given the governorship of Lahore and Multan.
- Khizr Khan's three successors—*Mubarak Shah* (1421-33), *Mohammed Shah* (1434-43) and *Ala-ud-din Alam Shah* (1443-51) assumed the royal title of Sultan and ruled as sovereign rulers, but all were incapable rulers.
- During the 27 years of Sayyid dynasty the sultanate of Delhi remained in trouble due to external invasions, internal intrigue, chaos and confusion. These conditions provided an opportunity to Bahlol Lodhi.
- Yahya-bin-Ahmed-bin-Abdullah Sirhindi wrote the *Tarikh-i-Mubarakshahi* (a history of Sultans of Delhi from time of Muizz-ud-Din, Muhammad-bin-Sam).

The Lodhis

The Lodhis, who ruled for 75 years were Afghans by race. The Lodhis were ruling over **Sirhind** when Sayyids, were in India.

Bahlol Lodhi

Bahlol Lodhi was the founder of the Lodhi dynasty. He was one of the Afghan Sardars, who established themselves in Punjab after the Timur's invasion. He introduced coins, he called his Sardar Masnad-i-Ali.

Sikandar Lodhi

- He was the noblest and ablest ruler of the 3rd Lodhi rulers. He set-up an efficient coinage system, military, spy network and also introduced the system of auditing of accounts.
- He repaired Qutub Minar. He introduced the measuring scale '*Gaz-i-Sikandari*' for measuring cultivated fields. He wrote Persian verses with the name of the *Gul-rukhi*.

- He founded Agra in 1504 and made it as his capital. He reimposed Jaziya. Women were prohibited to go on saint graves during his reign. He imposed ban on any language other than Persian.

Ibrahim Lodhi

He was not ablest ruler. He was defeated and killed by Babur in the *first Battle of Panipat* (1526) and sultanate period ended.

Administration under Delhi Sultanate

- Administration/Kingdom was divided into *iqtas*. The head of the civil administration was a *Wazir* (head of finance department).
- The Wazir was assisted by a deputy or Naib Wazir, an Accountant General (*Mushrif-i-mumalik*) and the Auditor General (*Maustauji-i-mumalik*).
- The chief justice was *Qazi-i-mumalik* (having both religious and secular functions). He was responsible for the enforcement of the *shariat*.
- The officer-in-charge of the royal correspondence army head was known by the name of *Ariz-i-mumalik* and he was responsible for all military works like-recruitment, payment, inspection of the troops.
- **Barid-i-Mumalik** The officer-in-charge of royal post and news agency.
- The provinces were divided into 'shiqs' under the control of 'Shiqdars'. The next unit was paraganas headed by munsifs.
- Iqta system prevailed under which land of the empire was divided into several large and small tracts called Iqta and were given to soldiers, officers and nobles.
Important departments were as follow
 - **Diwan-i-Insha** Department of correspondence
 - **Diwan-i-Ariz** Military department
 - **Diwan-i-Risalat** Department of appeals
 - **Diwan-i-Qaza-i-Mumalik** Department of Justice
 - **Diwan-i-Ishtikak** Department of pensions

Books	Author	Books	Authors
Alberuni	Tahkik-i-Hind	Amir Khusrau	Tarikh-i-Alai
Alberuni	Qanun-i-Masudi	Zia-ud-din Barani	Fatwa-i-Jahandari
Alberuni	Jawahar-i-Jawahar	Zia-ud-din Barani	Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi
Minhaj-us-Siraj	Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	Firoz Shah	Fatwa-i-Firoz Shahi
Amir Khusrau	Laila-Majnu, Quran-us-Saadin	Firozabadi	Qamus
Amir Khusrau	Khazain-ul-Futuh	Hassan Nizami	Taj-ul-Maathir
Amir Khusrau	Tughlaqnama	Abu Bakr	Chach Namah
Amir Khusrau	Nuh-Siphir	Fakhruddin	Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi
Amir Khusrau	Miftah-ul-Futuh	Shams-i-Shiraj Afif	Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi
Amir Khusrau	Ayina-i-Sikandari	Ibn Batutta	Kitab-ul-Rehla
Amir Khusrau	Hasht Bihsht	Isami	Futuh-us-Salatin
Amir Khusrau	Shirin Khusrau	Firdausi	Shahnamah

Structure	Location	Builder
Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque	Delhi	Qutub-ud-din Aibak
Adhai din ka Jhopra	Ajmer	Qutub-ud-din Aibak
Qutub Minar	Delhi	Iltutmish (Founded by Qutub-ud-din Aibak)
Tomb of Hazarat Nizamuddin Auliya	Delhi	Alauddin Khilji
Alai Darwaza	Delhi	Alauddin Khilji
Jammat Khana Masjid	Delhi	Alauddin Khilji
Tomb of Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq	Delhi	Muhammad Bin Tughlaq
Tughlaqabad Fort	Delhi	Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq
Moth ki Masjid	Delhi	Wazir Miya Bhoiya (Prime Minister of Sikandar Lodhi)

THE VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

- Vijayanagara kingdom was founded by Harihar I and Bukka I (Sons of Sangama), who were feudatories of Kakatiyas and later became ministers in the court of Kampili.
- Harihara** and **Bukka** were brought to the centre by Mohammed-bin-Tughlaq, converted to Islam and were sent to South again to control rebellion.
- Harihar and Bukka founded the Vijayanagara Empire in 1336 on the advice of Vidyaranya, who converted them back to Hindu.
- Vijayanagara Empire ruler believed in divinity and said they ruling by will of God Virupaksha. Idols of Vijayanagara rulers were also started to be kept in temples. Colonel Colin Mackenzie brought Hampi of Vijayanagara Empire into light in the AD 19th century.

Sangama Dynasty

Harihara I

He made Anagundi his capital. He annexed the Hoyasala State in AD 1364. When, the Muslim ruler of Mandurai defeated and killed the Hoyasala ruler Vir Ballal III.

Bukka I

- He made Gutti his capital. The war with Bahmanis started in AD 1367, during the reign of Bukka I. The Bahmani Sultan defeated Bukka I and after a long war concluded a treaty which restored the old positions.
- The empire saw expansion under Bukka I. His son Kumara Kampan successfully led an expedition against Madurai and annexed it. This is mentioned in Madura Vijayam written by Ganga Devi (Kampan's wife).

Harihara II

- Bukka I was succeeded by his son Harihara II, who embarked upon a policy of expansion towards the Eastern sea coast. This new policy of expansion consequently led the Vijayanagara Empire into fresh conflicts.

- This expansion was responsible for the alliance of the Bahmani kingdom with Warangal, which lasted for about 50 years and was a major factor in the inability of the Vijayanagara Empire to overrun the Tungabhadra doab or to stem the Bahmani offensive in the area.

Deva Raya I

- He assumed the title of **Maharajadhiraja**. The reign of Deva Raya I began with a renewed fight for the Tungabhadra doab.
- He was defeated by the Bahmani ruler, Firoz Shah and had to pay a huge indemnity. He also agreed to marry his daughter to the Sultan Deva Raya I who undertook a number of schemes for the welfare of the people.
- In AD 1410, he got constructed a dam across the Tungabhadra, with canals leading to the city. This greatly helped in agriculture. He was also a great patron of the scholars.
- Nicolo De Conti**, an Italian (Venetian), visited the Vijayanagara empire under Deva Raya I. Conti describes the city of Vijayanagara as having a circumference of 96 km and employing 90000 potential soldiers and also mentions the festivals like Deepawali, Navratri etc.



Few foreign travellers to India during Medieval Period

- Marco Polo** was an Italian traveller from Venice, who visited India in AD 1295.
- Nicolo De Conti** an Italian (Venetian) visited the Vijayanagara empire in 1419, is author of India Recognita.
- Abdur Razzaq** was an Uzbek Islamic scholar and ambassador of Shah Rukh, visited India from 1442-1445.
- Duarte Barbosa** was a missionary from Portugal and visited India in 1560.
- Fernao Nuniz** Portuguese traveller visited Vijayanagara during reign of Achayuta Raya.
- Nikitin** Russian merchant visited Bahmani kingdom.

Deva Raya II

- He was the greatest ruler of the Sangama dynasty. In order to strengthen his army, he inducted more Muslims and asked all his Hindu soldiers and officers to learn the art of archery from them.
- With his new army, he crossed the Tungabhadra river and tried to recover Mudkal, Bankapur etc which were to the South of the Krishna river and had been lost to the Bahmani Sultans. Three hard battles were fought, but at the end, the two sides had to agree to the existing frontiers.
- Deva Raya II was called Immadi Devaraya and also Proudha Devaraya or the great Devaraya by his subjects. Some quarter varahas (gold coins of Vijayanagara) of Deva Raya II describe him as Gajabetakara (the elephant hunter).

- Deva Raya II was a great patron of literature and himself an accomplished scholar in Sanskrit. He is credited with the authorship of two Sanskrit works Mahanataka Sudhanidhi and a commentary on the Brahma Sutras of Badarayana.
- The king had leaning for Vira Saivism, yet he showed tolerance in religious views. He appointed people belonging to different religions as his minister. He got constructed a mosque in the Vijayanagara and ordered that a copy of **Quran** be placed before his throne.

The Saluva Dynasty

- Vijayanagara witnessed chaos and disorder after 1465 due to weak rulers. However, the situation was saved by the Governor of Chandragiri, Narasimha Saluva, who seized the throne in about 1485 in what is known in history as the First Usurpation.
- Narasimha was succeeded by Timma and Imadi Narasimha, who were minors at the time of their coronation. The real power was in the hands of Narsa Nayak, who was the Regent.

The Tuluva Dynasty

Following the death of Narsa Nayak in 1505, his son Vira Narasimha, succeeded as the regent. He deposed Imadi Narasimha and laid the foundation of the Tuluva Dynasty by what is known in history as the Second Usurpation. Babur referred Krishna Deva Raya (1509-1529) as the greatest ruler of the Tuluva Dynasty.

Krishnadeva Raya

- He maintained friendly relations with Albuquerque, the Portuguese Governor, whose Ambassador Friar Luis was a resident in Vijayanagara.
- He gave **Albuquerque** permission to build a Fort of Bhatkal. He built the Vijaya Mahal (House of Victory) and expanded the Hazara Rama temple and the Vithal Swami temple.
- He took the titles of Yavanaraja Sthapanacharya (restorer of the Yavana kingdom, i.e. Bahmani) and Abhinava-Bhoja.
- He was also known as Andhra Pitamaha and Andhra Bhoja. He was a gifted scholar in both Telugu and Sanskrit of which only two works are extant.
- The Telugu work on polity Amuktamalyada and the Sanskrit drama Jambavati Kalyanam is also written by him. Krishna Deva Rai was also a great patron of art and literature, and was known as Andhra Bhoj.

Krishnadeva Raya's Ashtadiggajas

Krishnadeva Raya's court was adorned by following Ashtadiggajas (the eight celebrated poets)

- **Peddana**, who wrote Manucharitam and Harikathasaramu.

- **Timma**, who wrote Parijatapahara-vam.
- **Madaya**, who wrote Raja Shekarcharitam.
- **Dhurjate**, who wrote Kalahasti Mahatyam.
- **Surona**, who wrote Raghav Pandaviyam and Prabhavati Pradyuman.
- **Tenali Ramalingam**, who wrote Ponduranga Mahatyam.
- **Ayyalaraju Ramabhadra**, who wrote Sakalamata sara Sangraha.
- **Rama Raja Bhushan** was the eighth poet.

After Krishnadeva Raya, there was a period of confusion, following which Achayuta Rai ascended the throne and ruled upto 1542. Sadasiva Raya followed Achyuta Ray and ruled upto 1570.

The Aravidu Dynasty

The Aravidu Dynasty was founded by **Thirumala II**, the brother of Rama Raja, who ruled in the name of Sadasiva Raya. On his failure to repopulate Vijayanagara, he shifted the capital to Penugonda. During his rule, the Nayaks became independents. Tirumala then divided his empire into three practically linguistic sections and placed them under his sons.

BAHAMANI KINGDOM

- The Bahamani kingdom of Deccan was founded by Hasan Gangu, whose original name was Ismail Mukh. The capital was Gulbarga. Hasan Gangu took the title of Ala-ud-din Hasan, Bahaman Shah (AD 1347-58) and became the first king of Bahamani in AD 1347.
- He renamed Gulbarga as Ahsanabad. At the time of his death his dominion had four provinces Gulbarga, Daulatabad, Berar and Bidar.
- **Mahmud Shah I** (1358-75) son of Bahaman Shah established a council consisting of eight ministers and decentralised his provincial administration. He fought with Vijayanagara.
- **Firoz Shah** (1397-1422) was the most remarkable figure in Bahamani kingdom. He was determined to make Deccan the cultural centre of India. He inducted Hindus in his administration to large extent. He built an observatory at Daulatabad. He founded city of Firozabad on the bank of river Bhima. Firoz defeated Devaraya I.
- Firoz Shah was succeeded by his brother Ahmed Shah I (AD 1422-36). He shifted his capital from Gulbarga to Bidar, Ahmed Shah is known as Wali or saint due to his association with Gesu Daraz.
- Humayun was succeeded by his son Nizam Shah (1461-63) and then by Mohammed Shah III (AD 1463-82). Mahmud Gawan was the Prime Minister of Mohammed. Bahamani kingdom saw a resurgence under Mahmud Gawan's guidance. His military conquests included Konkan, Goa and Krishna-Godavari Delta, Nikitin a Russian merchant, visited Bidar during his reign.